"When a community starts educating itself," says Jitesh Gujjar, "it realises its past was glorious but not presented accurately and needs rectification"

with the Veer Gurjar Mahasabha and is leading the battle to reclaim the legacy of Rai Pithora, as Prithviraj III was also called. "When a community starts reading and educating itself," he says, "it realises its past was very glorious but was distorted or not presented accurately. The community then starts asserting itself to rectify the wrong portrayal, which is what the Gurjars are doing now."

To buttress his claim, Jitesh invokes Jayanaka's epic, written most likely between the first and second battles of Tarain, which uses the word Gurjaradhipati for Prithviraj's father Someshwar. If the father was a Gurjar, would the son not be a Gurjar too? He also refers to Bardai's *Raso*, citing the verse '*Gurjar ahir as jati doi, tin lil lok sake na koi*' to assert that the poet is using Gurjar here for caste rather than an area the community is said to represent.

Raso, whose historicity and scholarship remain uncertain and which is believed to have been written 500 years after Prithviraj's actual reign, as Cynthia Talbot, professor of history at the University of Texas, Austin, outlines in her 2016 book, *The Last Hindu Emperor*, depicts the Chauhans as one of the four Rajput Agnivanshi clans—the other three being the Pratiharas, Parmars and Chalukyas—born of sacrificial fire. It's a view echoed in later texts. However, in Jayanaka's telling of the legend of Prithviraj, the Chauhans were Sooryavanshis, or descendants of

#BeTheBetterGuy
A Road Safety Initiative

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ROAD SAFETY DRIVE

Now in its third season, the **#BeTheBetterGuy** campaign is leaving no stones unturned to drive home the importance of safe driving habits and bringing about a positive change by making Indian roads safer.

Staying true to its purpose of raising awareness about road safety, a two-day activation took place in Delhi/NCR, with promoters visiting prominent locations including Rajender Place, Nehru Place, Madhuban Chowk, Rajnigandha Chowk, Noida City Center, Huda City Centre, Sikandarpur Chowk and Bristol Chowk to spread the word.

To educate the millennial and Gen-Z about the benefits of practicing safe driving habits and making Indian roads safer, the promoters displayed placards with impactful messaging and handed out an Auto Today booklet containing road safety rules.

Over the years, the **#BeTheBetterGuy** campaign has been a strong voice in the road safety domain and has influenced quite a few motorists in India to become better and safer drivers and practice road safety in their everyday lives.

Now in its third season the campaign has already raised awareness about over-speeding, wrong side driving, right position, and posture for driving and the importance of wearing a seat belt.

Let us all pledge to **#BeTheBetterGuy** and do our bit for road safety and making Indian roads safer for everyone.







